



Workforce Skills For Business 2030: Navigating The Future Of Work In An AI-Augmented Economy

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Received: 03/07/2026 | Revised: 09/07/2026 | Accepted: 15/07/2026 | Published: 17/07/2026

Abstract

The accelerating convergence of Artificial Intelligence, automation, and digital transformation is fundamentally reshaping the skills landscape for the global business workforce. This paper investigates the critical workforce skills that will define organisational competitiveness by 2030, with a focus on Indian businesses in a digitally transforming economy.

A sequential exploratory mixed-methods design is employed: first, a three-round Delphi methodology with a panel of 42 industry experts across seven sectors, followed by a quantitative survey of 278 HR professionals and business leaders.

The findings yield a validated Future Skills Taxonomy for Business 2030 comprising four clusters - Digital & Technological Literacy, Cognitive & Analytical Agility, Human-Centred Leadership, and Adaptive Collaboration.

Three hypotheses are tested through multiple regression analysis: learning culture ($\beta = 0.44$), leadership commitment ($\beta = 0.38$), and L&D budget allocation ($\beta = 0.29$) are the strongest predictors of reskilling programme effectiveness ($R^2 = 0.613$).

A critical finding is that 79.3% of organisations acknowledge the urgency of future-skills development, yet only 34.7% have implemented systematic reskilling programmes. The paper proposes a Dynamic Workforce Capability Framework (DWCF) that integrates individual development, organisational learning, and national policy enablement.

Keywords: *Future of Work, Workforce Skills, Reskilling, AI Augmentation, Human Capital, Business 2030*



1. Introduction & Theoretical Framework

Grounded in Human Capital Theory (Becker, 1964), Dynamic Capabilities Theory (Teece et al., 1997), and Sociocognitive Theory of Career Development (Lent et al., 1994), this study develops the Dynamic Workforce Capability Framework (DWCF) integrating Individual (Growth Mindset and AI Literacy), Organisational (Learning Culture and L&D Investment), and Institutional (NEP Alignment and Skill India) pillars.



2. Research Methodology (Delphi & Survey)

A sequential exploratory mixed-methods design was employed across seven sectors (IT/ITES, banking, manufacturing, retail, healthcare, consulting, and logistics). Phase 1 utilised a three-round Delphi panel of 42 experts ($\geq 75\%$ consensus threshold) producing 24 skill items across four clusters. Phase 2 surveyed 278 HR professionals and senior leaders (92.7% response rate).



2. Research Methodology (Delphi & Survey) (Continued)

A sequential exploratory mixed-methods design was employed across seven sectors (IT/ITES, banking, manufacturing, retail, healthcare, consulting, and logistics). Phase 1 utilised a three-round Delphi panel of 42 experts ($\geq 75\%$ consensus threshold) producing 24 skill items across four clusters. Phase 2 surveyed 278 HR professionals and senior leaders (92.7% response rate).



3. Skills Gap Analysis & Multiple Regression

Digital & Technological Literacy recorded the largest gap (Current Mean = 2.13, Required 2030 Mean = 5.00, Gap Score = 3.87 - Critical), followed by Adaptive Collaboration (Gap = 3.61 - High) and Cognitive & Analytical Agility (Gap = 3.46 - High). One-way ANOVA confirmed significant industry differences in reskilling readiness ($F = 8.43$, $p < .001$), with IT/ITES highest (3.72) and Manufacturing lowest (2.31). Multiple regression confirmed Learning Culture ($\beta = 0.44$), Leadership Commitment ($\beta = 0.38$), and L&D Budget Allocation ($\beta = 0.29$) explain 61.3% of variance in reskilling effectiveness ($R^2 = 0.613$).



3. Skills Gap Analysis & Multiple Regression (Continued)

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4. Conclusions

The dominance of learning culture ($\beta = 0.44$) over L&D budget ($\beta = 0.29$) demonstrates that organisations extract substantially greater value from existing budgets when they cultivate a culture of continuous learning alongside targeted AI literacy programmes.



4. Conclusions (Continued)

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SRCAA Global Review of Contemporary Research (SGRCR)

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